MFFCP Administration Guide

A task-oriented reference for operators of the Madagascar Freshwater Fish Conservation Platform Django admin.

Admin URL: https://api.malagasyfishes.org/admin/ **Local dev:** http://localhost:8000/admin/

Sign in with a superuser (Tier 5) or a staff account with the right tier. Tier gates are enforced on specific models — see each section.

Quick-find: "I need to edit X, where do I go?"

I want to...	App → Model	Notes
Add or edit a species	**Species → Species**	Core taxonomy, silhouette, narrative
Add a species silhouette (species-level)	**Species → Species** → open species → `silhouette_svg` field	Paste SVG markup; width/height stripped on save
Add a silhouette at the **genus** level (fallback)	**Species → Genus** → open genus → `silhouette_svg` field	Used when a species has no silhouette of its own
Change a species' IUCN category	**Species → Conservation assessments → Add** (source = manual_expert)	**Do NOT edit `iucn_status` on Species directly** — it's a mirror
Upload the home hero image	**Species → Site map assets** → find row with key `hero_thumb` → upload	Pre-seeded; edit, don't add
Upload the species-profile distribution panel image	**Species → Site map assets** → find row with key `profile_panel` → upload	Same pattern
Edit a watershed / drainage basin	**Species → Watersheds**	Read-only (HyBAS mirror) — contact dev to re-import
Add a locality / occurrence record	**Species → Species localities**	GIS map picker; check `needs_review` to quarantine
Add a common name for a species	**Species → Species** → open species → Common names inline	Tabular inline at bottom of species form. Set `language` to ISO 639-1 code (en, mg, fr, de). Public profile groups by language.
Add an institution holding captive fish	**Populations → Institutions**	
Record a captive population	**Populations → Ex situ populations**	Tier 3–4 scoped to own institution
Log a census snapshot	**Populations → Ex situ populations** → open row →	Reporter auto-fills to current user

	Holding records inline	
Add husbandry guidance	**Husbandry → Species husbandry**	Publishing requires ≥1 source + reviewer
Record a field program	**Fieldwork → Field programs**	M2M to focal species and partner institutions
Check an IUCN sync run	**Integration → Sync jobs**	Read-only log
Invite a user / change tier	**Accounts → Users**	Superuser only for tier/privilege edits
Review an IUCN↔manual conflict	**Species → Conservation status conflicts**	Tier 3+; resolve or dismiss
Audit who changed an IUCN status	**Audit → Audit entries**	Tier 5 only (append-only)

App-by-app reference

Species

The core taxonomic and conservation-data app. Most day-to-day editing happens here.

- **Genus** — genus record. Holds the **genus-level silhouette fallback**. If a species has no silhouette of its own, cards fall back to this one. Paste inline SVG markup into `silhouette_svg`; width/height attributes are stripped automatically on save so cards render cleanly.
- **Species** — the canonical species row. Fields include scientific name, authority, taxon hierarchy, endemic status, undescribed flag, `silhouette_svg` (species-level override), narrative prose, and `iucn_status`.
  - **`iucn_status` is a read-only mirror.** It reflects the most recent accepted `ConservationAssessment`. To change the badge, add an assessment (see below), don't edit this field.
  - Inlines on the species detail page: Conservation Assessments, Common Names, Species Localities.
  - Tier 3+ users see a "Recent iucn_status changes" audit strip at the bottom of the form.
- **Conservation assessments** — individual IUCN or manual-expert assessment records. Adding one with `source=manual_expert` requires a category, assessor, assessment date, notes, and a free-text **reason** (captured for audit). Tier 3+ only for add/change. An accepted new assessment updates `Species.iucn_status` automatically via the mirror policy.
- **Conservation status conflicts** — raised automatically when an IUCN sync brings in a category that disagrees with a manual expert assessment. Tier 3+ can resolve by picking one of:
  - `accepted_iucn` (supersede the manual assessment),
  - `retained_manual` (keep the manual, flag IUCN record as dissenting),
  - `reconciled` (create a new reconciled assessment),
  - `dismissed` (noise / false positive).
- **Site map assets** — curated static map thumbnails used by the frontend. Pre-seeded with two rows: **`hero_thumb`** (home page hero) and **`profile_panel`** (species-profile Distribution panel). Open the row and upload a new image; save triggers a revalidation of affected public pages.

- **Taxon** — taxonomic hierarchy rows (family → subfamily → etc.). Edit when you need to add a new family or reclassify.
- **Species localities** — occurrence records with GIS coordinates. Admin uses a map picker. Key flags:
  - `is_sensitive` — editable only by superusers; triggers coordinate generalization for public viewers.
  - `needs_review` — hides the record from the public map until cleared.
  - `location_generalized`, `drainage_basin_name` — auto-computed on save; read-only.
- **Watersheds** — HyBAS drainage-basin polygons (Pfafstetter level-12). **Read-only mirror** of the HyBAS import. To add or correct a basin, coordinate with a developer to re-run the import.
- **Protected areas** — WDPA-sourced protected-area polygons. Also a **read-only mirror**.

Populations

Ex-situ coordination data. Tier-scoped.

- **Institutions** — zoos, aquariums, research orgs, hobbyist programs. Includes membership flags (ZIMS, EAZA, AZA) used by coordinator-tier filters.
- **Ex-situ populations** — one row per (species, institution) pair. **Tier 3–4 users can only write to their own institution.** Tier 1–2 are read-only. Holding Records are an inline on the detail form.
- **Holding records** — dated census snapshots (total/male/female/unknown counts) for a population. `reporter` is auto-filled on create from the logged-in user.

Husbandry

Hobbyist captive-care guidance, published under an editorial gate.

- **Species husbandry** — water parameters, tank, diet, behavior, breeding, difficulty, sourcing. Publishing (`published=True`) is **blocked** unless the record has a `last_reviewed_by`, `last_reviewed_at`, **and** at least one `HusbandrySource`. A stale- review warning appears on the form if the last review is >730 days old.
- **Husbandry sources** — citations / references for a husbandry record. Normally edited via the inline on the parent species-husbandry form.

Fieldwork

In-situ program tracking.

- **Field programs** — program or survey record with dates, lead institution, and many-to-many links to focal species and partner institutions.

Integration

External-system sync telemetry.

- **Sync jobs** — log of IUCN API sync runs (pending / running / completed / failed). **Read-only** — add/change/delete are disabled. Use this to investigate when a species' mirror last updated or why an ingest failed; look at `records_skipped` and `error_log`.

Accounts

Platform users and their own audit log.

- **Users** — platform accounts with an `access_tier` (1 Public, 2 Researcher, 3 Coordinator, 4 Program Manager, 5 Admin) and an optional institution affiliation. **Only superusers can edit tier, `is_active`, `is_staff`, or `is_superuser`.**

- **Audit logs** — user-action audit (create / update / delete) with timestamp, IP, and a JSON diff. Read-only.

Audit

Append-only conservation-status governance log, separate from the general Accounts audit.

- **Audit entries** — every change to `Species.iucn_status` or to a `ConservationAssessment` row. **Tier 5 (superuser) only** for the global list. Tier 3+ users can see scoped entries for a species from inside that species' detail form (the "Recent iucn_status changes" block). **The table is append-only** — the admin disables add / change / delete, and the model raises `PermissionError` on any attempt to modify or delete an entry programmatically.

Common workflows

Add a new species

1. **Species → Taxon** — confirm the family / genus exists; add if needed.
2. **Species → Genus** — confirm the genus row exists; add if needed, including a genus-level silhouette if one is available.
3. **Species → Species → Add species.**
   - Fill taxonomy, endemic status, authority, narrative.
   - Paste species-level `silhouette_svg` if you have one — otherwise the genus fallback will be used.
   - Leave `iucn_status` alone — it will populate from step 4.
4. **Species → Conservation assessments → Add** referencing the new species, with `source=manual_expert` (or wait for the next IUCN sync if the species has an `iucn_taxon_id`). This sets the public badge.
5. (Optional) Add **Common names** inline on the species form. Use ISO 639-1 language codes (`en` , `mg` , `fr` , `de` , `es` , …). The public profile's Common Names panel groups entries by language — English, Malagasy, French, German appear first in that order; other codes fall through alphabetically. Unknown codes render with the uppercased code as a label rather than disappearing.

Add or replace a silhouette

Species-level (highest priority): Species → Species → open the row → paste SVG markup into `silhouette_svg` → Save. Width and height attributes on the root `<svg>` are stripped automatically — the frontend sizes to the card.

Genus-level (fallback when species has none): Species → Genus → open the row → paste SVG markup into `silhouette_svg` → Save. Affects every species in that genus that has no species-level silhouette.

Change a species' IUCN category

Do **not** edit `Species.iucn_status` directly.

1. Species → Conservation assessments → Add.
2. Pick the species, `source=manual_expert` , set category, assessor, assessment date, and notes.
3. Fill in the **reason** field (free text; captured in the audit).
4. Save. The species mirror picks up the new category via the same code path that handles IUCN syncs.
5. If your new assessment disagrees with an existing IUCN assessment, a **Conservation status conflict** row will be created — resolve it from that list.

Upload a new home-page hero image

1. Species → Site map assets.
2. Find the row with **Key = hero_thumb** (pre-seeded — don't add a new row).
3. Open it, upload the new image, update credit/alt text.
4. Save. The home page will revalidate automatically.

Same pattern for the species profile Distribution panel, using the row with **Key = profile_panel**.

Record a new captive population

1. Populations → Institutions — confirm the institution exists; add if not.
2. Populations → Ex-situ populations → Add.
3. Pick species and institution. Tier 3–4 users are constrained to their own institution automatically.
4. Save, then use the **Holding records** inline to add a census snapshot.

Review a conservation-status conflict

1. Species → Conservation status conflicts — filter to unresolved.
2. Open the conflict. You'll see the manual assessment and the incoming IUCN assessment side by side.
3. Pick a resolution (`accepted_iucn` , `retained_manual` , `reconciled` , or `dismissed`) and, for `reconciled` , set the reconciled category.
4. Save. The chosen resolution cascades: superseded assessments are marked, a reconciled assessment row may be created, and the mirror is updated.

Tier reference

Tier	Role	Admin reach
1	Public	No admin access
2	Registered Researcher	Read-only on most species / population rows
3	Conservation Coordinator	Add/change Conservation Assessments, Conflicts, scoped audit view
4	Program Manager	Ex-situ populations for own institution, studbook-level fields
5	Administrator / superuser	Full admin, user management, audit list

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Things that look editable but aren't (on purpose)

- **`Species.iucn_status`** — mirror of latest accepted assessment. Route all changes through `ConservationAssessment` .
- **Watersheds, Protected areas** — HyBAS / WDPA mirrors. Re-imported by devs.
- **Sync jobs, Audit entries, Audit logs** — append-only logs.
- **`SpeciesLocality.location_generalized` , `SpeciesLocality.drainage_basin_name`** — computed on save.
- **`HoldingRecord.reporter`** — auto-filled from the logged-in user on create.